

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 29, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 33:1-9

1 Again the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, speak to the children of your people, and say to them: 'When I bring the sword upon a land, and the people of the land take a man from their territory and make him their watchman,

3 when he sees the sword coming upon the land, if he blows the trumpet and warns the people,

4 then whoever hears the sound of the trumpet and does not take warning, if the sword comes and takes him away, his blood shall be on his own head.

5 He heard the sound of the trumpet, but did not take warning; his blood shall be upon himself. But he who takes warning will save his life.

6 But if the watchman sees the sword coming and does not blow the trumpet, and the people are not warned, and the sword comes and takes any person from among them, he is taken away in his iniquity; but his blood I will require at the watchman's hand.'

7 So you, son of man: I have made you a watchman for the house of Israel; therefore you shall hear a word from My mouth and warn them for Me.

8 When I say to the wicked, 'O wicked man, you shall surely die!' and you do not speak to warn the wicked from his way, that wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood I will require at your hand.

9 Nevertheless if you warn the wicked to turn from his way, and he does not turn from his way, he shall die in his iniquity; but you have delivered your soul."

II. Key Summary

- God uses the picture of a watchman: when the sword comes upon a land, the

people pick one man from among them to be their watchman, and when he sees the danger coming he blows the trumpet to warn everyone.

- Whoever hears the trumpet and ignores it has his blood on his own head; but if the watchman sees the sword and does not blow the trumpet, God will require that person's blood at the watchman's hand.
 - God says He has made Ezekiel a watchman for the house of Israel, to hear a word from God's mouth and warn the people for Him; if Ezekiel warns and the person still does not turn, Ezekiel has delivered his own soul.
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III. Passage Analysis

The warning isn't a scare tactic — it's a chance to turn back

In His grace God had mercy on them and gave them a last chance to repent. So God appointed the watchman to warn them and wake them up, and the watchman had to take up that responsibility and warn. If they do not repent, that is their responsibility. But if the watchman does not warn, the guilt falls on the watchman. [1]

God blows this trumpet because He wants people to have a chance to turn around, not because He wants them gone. So once the warning reaches your ears, what you do with it is now in your hands.

Your part is to speak; whether they listen is on them

If the watchman faithfully delivered his message, then the response of the one he warned was the responsibility of the one who heard it. It could be said to the watchman, you have delivered your soul. [2]

Ezekiel's job was to open his mouth; what the other person decided after that was their own call. So if you often feel like "saying something won't change anything," this is for you: once you've said it, you've done your part.

IV. Reflection Question

When you can see that a friend is headed for real trouble if they keep going, what makes

you decide whether to say something to them?

The watchman blew the trumpet to warn the people because he saw the sword coming; God made Ezekiel a watchman, and what He handed him was the job of speaking up — whether the other person turned was never charged to Ezekiel's account.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy.org), Yau-Chi Tong, Tien Dao Bible Commentary — Ezekiel (translated from Chinese),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT33.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 33,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-33/>